1. Purpose

To establish a rigorous, verifiable system to track all food products, raw materials, and food-contact packaging throughout the restaurant's supply chain. In strict compliance with the Food Safety Act of 2013 (RA 10611), this protocol ensures the company and brand can execute the "one step back, one step forward" traceability mandate. In the event of a recognized food safety hazard, this document provides the operational framework to rapidly execute, preventing further food adulteration, and fulfilling all regulatory reporting obligations to the Local Government Unit (LGU) and the Food and Drug Administration (FDA).

2. Scope

Applies to all facets of the restaurant's food operations. It covers the receiving of raw materials from approved suppliers, internal storage and batch preparation, and the final service of dispatch of menu items (including dine-in, take out, and third-party deliveries). It encompasses all employees involved in purchasing, receiving, kitchen, and front of house service.

3. Responsibilities

3.1. Food Safety Compliance Officer (FSCO)/ Quality Assurance

Shall have the ultimate authority to initiate a product recall. Responsible for notifying regulatory agencies (FDA/LGU) and overseeing the execution of annual mock recalls.

3.2. Purchasing/ Supply Chain Manager

Shall be responsible for enforcing "one step back" traceability by ensuring all incoming deliveries are accompanied by valid Delivery Receipts (DR), Certificate of Analysis (COA), and batch/lot numbers.

3.3. Area Manager

Shall be responsible for internal traceability, ensuring that all prepped ingredients are accurately labeled with dates and batch codes, and that First In, First Out (FIFO) or First Expiry, First Out (FEFO) protocols are strictly followed.

3.4. Restaurant Manager, Shift Manager, and Kitchen Captain

Shall be responsible for "one step forward" traceability, utilizing Point of Sale (POS) date and reservation/delivery logs to identify which guests may have consumed compromised batches.

4. Definition of Terms

- **Product traceability:** A systematic ability to follow the movement of food, ingredients, and packaging materials through every stage of procurement, preparation, and distribution. Operating on the "one step back, one step forward" principle, this protocol requires Food Business Operators (FBOs) to maintain meticulous records identifying the immediate previous source of all raw materials and the immediate subsequent recipient of finished products. This framework serves as a vital tool for public health protection, enabling the rapid identification of contamination sources and the surgical isolation of compromised batches during food safety crises. Ultimately, a robust traceability system ensures operational transparency, facilitates efficient product recalls, and upholds the company's legal accountability within the national food safety infrastructure.
- **Product Recall:** A systematic removal of a food item from the supply chain or service cycle due to identified risks of adulteration, mislabeling, or contamination that may jeopardize

public health. This administrative procedure serves as a critical risk-management strategy, allowing Food Business Operators (FBOs) to mitigate potential liability and consumer harm by proactively or reactively isolating and disposing of compromised inventory. Whether initiated voluntarily by the company or mandated by regulatory authorities such as the FDA or Local Government Units (LGUs), a formal recall encompasses the immediate cessation of sale, the physical quarantine of affected batches, and the transparent notification of all stakeholders to ensure the complete elimination of biological, chemical, or physical hazards from the food ecosystem.

- **Adulteration:** The intentional or accidental addition of an impure, unauthorized, or hazardous substance into a food product, compromising its safety, quality, and legal compliance under RA 10611.
- **High-Risk Items:** Raw materials that are highly susceptible to biological, chemical, or physical contamination—specifically raw meats, poultry, seafood, and dairy products—requiring strict temperature controls and batch tracking.
- **Batch/Lot Number:** A unique combination of numbers, letters, or symbols assigned by the manufacturer or supplier to a specific quantity of food or materials produced under virtually identical conditions, enabling precise isolation during a recall.
- **Quarantine:** The physical segregation and distinct labeling of affected or suspected inventory in a designated secure area to prevent its unauthorized use, processing, or distribution.
- **Root Cause Analysis (RCA):** A structured, investigative methodology used by management to identify the underlying systemic failure or vulnerability that allowed a food safety deviation or contamination to occur.
- **Mock Recall:** A planned, simulated crisis exercise executed at least once annually to test and evaluate the readiness, speed, and accuracy of the restaurant's traceability infrastructure and tracking systems.

5. Supplier Traceability (One Step Back)

Upon delivery , all raw materials must be recorded in the **Receiving Log**. This entry must capture the Supplier name, Date of Receipt, Product Description, Batch/Lot Number, Expiration Date, and Invoice/DR Number.

Any high-risk items (raw meats, dairy products) lacking proper batch identification or arriving at unsafe temperatures must be immediately rejected and recorded in the **Supplier Feedback Report (SFR)**.

6. Internal Traceability

To maintain rigorous internal traceability throughout the culinary process, all raw materials transitioned into sub-recipes must be stored in secondary containers clearly marked with the preparation date, expiration date, and a cross-reference to the original supplier’s batch identification number. This labeling protocol must be supported by the maintenance of comprehensive daily production logs that facilitate a direct, auditable link between the specific lot numbers of high-risk raw materials and their corresponding date of utilization within the kitchen. Such documentation ensures that in the event of a safety deviation, the company can precisely identify and isolate all finished products containing potentially compromised ingredients.

7. Service Traceability

By leveraging high-fidelity transaction data from the Point of Sale (POS) system and integrated third-party delivery applications, the company facilitates the forensic mapping of menu item distribution, thereby empowering the Food Safety Compliance Officer (FSCO) or Quality Assurance (QA) to accurately isolate specific exposure timeframes and identify affected consumer cohorts during a reported health hazard or product recall investigation.

8. Recall Initiation and Execution Protocol

If a food safety hazard is identified (e.g., a supplier notification of contaminated product, or multiple guest reports of foodborne illness linked to a specific dish), the following steps are mandatory:

- **Stop Process:** The FSCO or QA immediately halts the preparation and sale of the implicated item.
- **Quarantine:** All remaining inventory of the implicated raw material and any prepped items containing it must be immediately physically isolated. They must be placed in a secure area and conspicuously tagged with **"RECALL: DO NOT USE/ NOT FOR CONSUMPTION."**
- **Inventory Reconciliation:** The Kitchen Captain/ Shift Manager will calculate the total amount received versus the total amount consumed to determine exactly how much of the hazardous product reached consumers.

9. Regulatory Notification and Remediation

In the event that compromised products have been distributed to the public, the Food Safety Compliance Officer (FSCO) is mandated by RA 10611 to execute formal notifications to the local City Health Office (CHO) and, when applicable, the FDA within statutory timeframes. Concurrently, all quarantined inventory must undergo secure, documented destruction under the direct observation of the FSCO to guarantee its absolute removal from the food supply chain. To conclude the remediation process and ensure long-term compliance, management must perform a rigorous Root Cause Analysis (RCA) to pinpoint the systemic failure, thereby enabling the implementation of documented corrective actions designed to prevent future recurrence.

10. Mock Recalls

To validate the operational efficacy of the company's traceability infrastructure, the Food Safety Compliance Officer (FSCO) is required to facilitate a comprehensive "Mock Recall" exercise at least once annually, serving as a rigorous stress test of the facility's crisis response capabilities. This simulation mandates that the food safety team demonstrate a seamless data trail for a randomly selected high-risk ingredient, successfully mapping its journey from the point of supplier reception through internal processing to the final customer transaction within a strictly defined four-hour window. By documenting this performance, the restaurant not only fulfills the "one step back, one step forward" requirements of the Food Safety Act of 2013 but also identifies potential informational gaps, ensuring that the team remains prepared to execute a surgical and rapid withdrawal of products during an actual public health emergency.

11. Verification

To ensure full compliance with the Food Safety Act of 2013 (RA 10611), the establishment mandates a structured verification system consisting of daily log reviews by Restaurant and Shift Managers or Kitchen Captains, weekly unannounced storage audits by Area Managers, and a mandatory annual mock recall led by the Food Safety Compliance Office (FSCO) or Quality Assurance (QA). Furthermore, in cases of actual or failed mock recalls, the FSCO or QA must verify that a Root Cause Analysis (RCA) is conducted and corrective actions are documented, while all traceability records must be securely archived for immediate inspection by the LGU and FDA.

12. Change History

Revision No.:	Revision Date:	Author & Position:	Purpose of Revision
0	March 09, 2026	Marielle Louise Macabale**, QA Specialist**	Originator
1	June 2, 2026	Celine Joy Sanchez**, QA Specialist**	• Added more Definition of Terms and Verification

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